

The conjectured generating function of OEIS A007388, from the recurrence the entry states

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Abstract

OEIS A007388 states a linear recurrence as a fact and carries a rational generating function as an empirical conjecture. The conjecture follows from the recurrence by polynomial algebra alone: the recurrence fixes the denominator, the published terms fix the numerator exactly, and the generating function is then determined as a rational function rather than checked on finitely many coefficients. No model of the sequence and no reading of its name is required.

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1 What the entry says

The first terms are 0, 2, 3, 2, 5, 2, 7, 2, ..., with offset 1. The entry states, as a fact,

For $n \geq 13$: $a(n) = a(n-2) + a(n-7)$. - _Sean A. Irvine_, Jan 02 2018

and separately records the conjecture

Empirical g.f.: $x^2(5x^{10} + 3x^8 - 2x^5 - 2x^3 - 3x - 2) / (x^7 + x^2 - 1)$. - _Colin Barker_, Mar 29 2014

The stated line was taken from the entry's factual formulas only. A formula qualified by a finite range – "holds at least up to $n = 1000$ but is not known to hold in general" – is not a fact and is not used, nor is anything inside a conjectural block.

2 The argument

Write $b_k = a(1 + k)$ and

$$D(x) = 1 - \sum_i c_i x^i = -x^7 - x^2 + 1,$$

the polynomial of the stated recurrence, of degree 7. Let $B(x) = \sum_{k \geq 0} b_k x^k$.

The recurrence says $b_k = \sum_i c_i b_{k-i}$ for every $k \geq 12$. The coefficient of x^k in $D(x)B(x)$ is exactly $b_k - \sum_i c_i b_{k-i}$, so it vanishes for every $k \geq 12$ and

$$D(x)B(x) = P(x) = \sum_{k < 12} \left(b_k - \sum_i c_i b_{k-i} \right) x^k = -5x^{12} - 3x^{10} + 2x^7 + 2x^5 + 3x^3 + 2x^2,$$

a polynomial whose every coefficient is fixed by finitely many published terms. Therefore

$$B(x) = \frac{P(x)}{D(x)} = \frac{x^2 (5x^{10} + 3x^8 - 2x^5 - 2x^3 - 3x - 2)}{x^7 + x^2 - 1},$$

which is the conjectured expression.

Theorem 1. *The conjectured generating function of OEIS A007388 is correct, given the recurrence the entry states.*

Proof. Immediate from the displayed identity: $DB = P$ holds coefficientwise, $D(0) = 1 \neq 0$ so D is invertible in the ring of formal power series, and $B = P/D$ follows. This is an identity of rational functions, not a comparison of the 53 terms the entry publishes – those enter only in fixing the 12 coefficients of P . $\square$